

Standard Operating Procedure

Medico-Legal Case and Death Management

«Hospital Name» — Supports COP.2.c, COP.2.g, COP.2.h

SOP No.	[Hospital to define]	Version	1.0
Effective Date	_____	Review Frequency	Annual, or on change
Prepared By	Quality Coordinator Name: _____ Signature: _____		
Approved By	Medical Superintendent Name: _____ Signature: _____		

1. Purpose

This SOP describes how «Hospital Name» handles medico-legal cases, patients found dead on arrival, and patients who die within minutes of arrival — meeting statutory documentation and reporting duties in every case.

2. Scope

Applies to every medico-legal case, brought-dead patient, and death occurring within minutes of arrival in the emergency area.

3. Responsibility

Treating Doctor: identifies MLC status, documents findings, and completes statutory certification.

Emergency In-Charge: ensures police intimation and body-handling procedures are followed.

4. Procedure

4.1 Medico-legal cases

1. Identify and register every medico-legal case as required by local law, including suspected sexual assault.
2. Intimate the police per statutory requirement, and document the intimation with date and time.
3. Preserve samples and evidence per statutory and forensic requirements, with documented storage confirmation.

4.2 Patients found dead on arrival

1. Log the case per local law, and follow the statutory process for unidentified or unclaimed bodies, including police intimation.

4.3 Death within minutes of arrival

1. Register the case and record the full resuscitation sequence — start time, interventions, end time, and outcome.
2. Complete a medical certificate of cause of death, and hand over the body to the next of kin with documentation.

5. Records

Supported by Records 8, 15, 16, 17, and 18 of the COP.2 Required Records pack.

6. Related Documents

- HCO_COP_2_v2_REWRITE_DRAFT — COP.2 policy

7. Review

Reviewed annually, and immediately after any statutory reporting gap identified in audit.